

Get Unstuck When You Do Not Know What To Do Next

Moving from “I do not know” to “I understand this better now”

There comes a time when we feel stuck — when we simply don’t know how to continue. It can feel like there’s no next step, no solution, nowhere to go. In reality, that’s rarely true. Being overwhelmed, worried, and stuck is natural. The following questions are designed to help you take a step back and get unstuck by looking at the situation from different perspectives.

WHAT ARE YOU WORKING ON?

Before you start, briefly describe the situation, goal, or decision you feel stuck on. The more specific, the better — you’ll refer back to this as you work through the prompts below.

01 Stop the Open-Ended Question

Trade “what are your next steps?” for something narrower. Multiple choice beats a blank page when you’re stuck.

- Of the options you’ve already thought about, which one feels most doable this week?

- If you could only do one thing before your next check-in, what would move the needle most?

- You’ve landed on “I don’t know” here before — what do you think is going on when that happens?

02 Find the Blocker

Sometimes the real issue isn't the plan — it's whatever is standing in front of it. Name that first.

- Is it that you're not sure what to do, or that you know but something's in the way?

- What makes this hard to answer right now?

- What would need to be true for you to know?

- Is this actually your goal — or one you agreed to because it seemed expected?

03 Lower the Bar

Stop looking for the right answer. Look for a pile of options instead — quantity over quality, no commitment required.

- List five things you could do. They don't have to be good ones, and you don't have to pick any of them.

- If you did know, what would it be?

- What's your best guess?

04 Make It Smaller

Big questions produce "I don't know." Small ones usually don't.

- What's one five-minute thing you could do today?

- If you can't answer for the whole goal, what's the smallest possible next step?

05 Externalize It

Borrow someone else's perspective — clarity is often easier to find for other people than for yourself.

- What would you tell a friend in this exact spot?

- What would you tell someone else facing the exact same situation?

Not sure which group to start with? Pick the one that sounds most like what's happening for you right now — there's no wrong place to begin.